

for broadcast data is wasteful and does not scale well. MobiTV is on a free trial at the moment, but the actual cost will be \$15, for a limited time (24 hours viewing per week). Other competition includes Qualcomm's MediaFlo, which the company is hoping to get off the ground.

In Korea, services exist using DMB (digital multimedia broadcast) and there are proposals for S-DMB (satellite digital multimedia broadcast), which would use a terrestrial repeater network to relay signals from satellites. DVB-H promoters label DMB as being too close to DAB. Designed for video, DVB-H gives more data per channel, say its backers.

Broadcasting to handsets could be very useful for information such as traffic and weather reports, or even warnings and emergency information. Like other broadcast services, it may also be possible to piggyback other data on it, perhaps including software upgrades for mobile devices, or updates to customer or product databases in devices carried by mobile workers.

More On DVB-H

DVB-H is the technology driving mobile TV. A combination of conventional digital video and IP, DVB-H scales for smaller devices a technology that's already in place in millions of TV sets worldwide.

Digital Video Broadcasting—Terrestrial (DVB-T), the current standard in digital video broadcasting, wasn't designed for mobile devices. However, as antenna technology improved, DVB-T mobile services became feasible, leading to extensive commercial trials. Digital TV reception on the move is an exciting advance in broadcasting.

However, handheld devices simply don't have the battery life to make DVB-T reception a viable option for consumers. A new solution was needed, DVB-H, or Digital Video Broadcast—Handheld, is that solution.